at 6,749m above sea level. In 1988, Pakistan made repeated attempts to take back the Quaid Post, but failed. The Siachen Glacier and the passes remain under Indian Army control at the time of writing.

Operation Pawan, 1987–90

Following Sri Lanka's independence in 1948, rising ethnic and political tensions between the majority Sinhalese and minority Tamil communities led to the emergence of militant groups advocating independence for Tamils, notably the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE), which sought to establish an *Eelam* (homeland). This led to a series of armed conflicts with the Sri Lankan military, with the counter-insurgency campaign being stepped up in 1986. On 26 May 1987, the Sri Lankan armed forces launched Operation *Vadamarachchi* (Liberation) against LTTE strongholds in the Jaffna Peninsula, resulting in large-scale civilian casualties and a humanitarian crisis. With its calls for a political settlement ignored by Sri Lanka, India announced on 2 June that it would send a relief convoy, but the Sri Lanka Navy forced it to turn back. After two days, the IAF mounted Operation *Poomalai* to provide humanitarian supplies to Jaffna.

Realizing the possibility of direct Indian military intervention, Sri Lanka lifted the siege of Jaffna. Signed on 29 July 1987, the Indo-Sri Lankan Accord provided an Indian Peace Keeping Force (IPKF) to 'guarantee and enforce the cessation of hostilities'. The lead elements of 54 Infantry Division were flown into Palali air base on 30 July, tasked with separating the belligerents, ensuring withdrawal of Sri Lankan armed forces to mutually agreed positions, supervising the laying down of arms by the various insurgent groups, clearing the minefields and creating a favourable environment for the conduct of provincial elections. Completing its induction by 4 August, the division was deployed over an area extending more than 250km, from the Jaffna Peninsula to Trincomalee.

On 6 October the IPKF launched Operation *Pawan*, an effort to disarm the militant groups, including the LTTE. On 10 October, the LTTE captured and killed five commandos of 10 PARA in Jaffna, prompting an Indian Army attempt to capture or eliminate the LTTE leadership. Para-commandos from 10 PARA (Cdo) and a company of 13 SIKH LI were to be flown into Jaffna and move to nearby Kokuvil to capture the LTTE